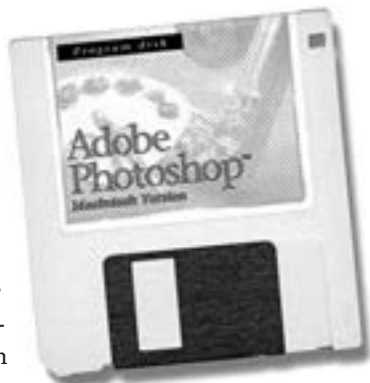


1.1 Photoshop's Curriculum Vitae

It all started with *Star Wars*. John Knoll, who worked for Industrial Light and Magic (ILM) at the time, envisioned the possibilities of computer-generated special effects, and decided to experiment with them himself, soliciting his brother Thomas' help for his purposes. Together, they invested in an Apple Macintosh II—the first one that supported colour—and began building on an



The First Photoshop Diskette

application John had started as a hobby: Display. One thing led to another, and as they added more and more features, Display became Photoshop 1.0, which was released in 1990 on a single floppy disk. While it was a big hit from the beginning, it wasn't until version 4.0 that Photoshop achieved its cult status as the ultimate in image editing, and has stayed there ever since.

What does it do?

Photoshop fanatics will probably make convincing arguments about how Photoshop is so awesome it can even cure world hunger, but there's probably still some time for that. What Photoshop is brilliant at is its original purpose—special effects. Using Photoshop, even the blandest image can be given a new lease on life. It doesn't end there, though. With its extremely powerful image-editing tools, Photoshop can be used to correct even the most disastrous flaws in pictures—from red eyes in photographs to undesirable smears of colour. ImageReady, which comes bundled with Photoshop, offers a host of features you can use for Web graphics—creating animated GIFs, mouse roll-overs, and some very aggressive compression tools that will ensure your images are the smallest possible size without compromising on their quality.